

LEARNING NEEDS SCREENING

Directions for WVAdultEd and Literacy Programs

Before proceeding to the questions, read this statement aloud to the student:

The following questions are about your school and life experiences.

We're trying to find out how it was for you (or your family members) when you were in school or how some of these issues might affect your life now.

Your responses to these questions will help identify resources and services you might need to be successful in completing your education or getting a job.

You are not required to answer if you are uncomfortable with specific questions.

1. Provide the student with a copy of the questions. Read the questions out loud to the student or group of students. Circle "Yes" or "No" for each question in Sections A, B, C, and D. **Note:** you may administer the screening to a group of students, having students circle their own answers, but the questions should still be read out loud.
2. **You must ask all 30 questions regardless of the score of the first 12 questions.** Count the number of "Yes" answers in Sections A, B, C, and D. Multiply the number of "Yes" responses in each section by the appropriate number below:
 - Section A total X 1
 - Section B total X 2
 - Section C total X 3
 - Section D total X 4
3. Record the number obtained for each section. To obtain a Total Score, add the subtotals from Sections A, B, C, and D and write the total at the bottom of the page. It is recommended that you ask all 30 questions.
4. Ask **all students** the **Additional Questions in Section E regardless of the score** in order to identify barriers to learning. These answers do not count in the tally) but may be used to determine referrals that need to be made. Many adults have other problems that are unrelated to disabilities that can affect their learning progress. You may need to make other referrals to local literacy providers, childcare providers, transportation assistance, etc.
5. **If the Total Score for Sections A-D is 12 or more, obtain records from the school system or physician regarding disability. You may need to refer the student for formal psychological assessment.** If you are making a referral for psychological assessment and will be sending the screening information along, you must have the student sign the *Release of Information* form. If the client has other issues (vision, hearing, etc.) identified in Section E, make additional referrals (vision specialist, audiologist, etc.).

Note: The 13 questions on Parts A-D of the *Learning Needs Screening* were developed for the Washington State Division of Employment and Social Services Learning Disabilities Initiative (November 1994 to June 1997) under contract by Nancie Payne, Senior Consultant, Payne & Associates, Olympia, Washington. Other parts of the screening have been adapted and modified for use with West Virginia Adult Education (WVAdultEd) students. The *Learning Needs Screening* is not a

diagnostic tool and should not be used to determine the existence of a disability. Its purpose is to determine who should be referred for formal assessment.

LEARNING NEEDS SCREENING

I am going to read this Learning Needs Screening out loud to you.

Name: _____

Date: _____

Please answer the following questions. Circle Yes or No.

Section A		
1.	Did you have any problems learning in middle school or junior high school?	Yes No
2.	Do any family members have learning problems?	Yes No
3.	Do you have difficulty working with numbers in columns?	Yes No
4.	Do you have trouble judging distances?	Yes No
5.	Do you have problems working from a test booklet to an answer sheet?	Yes No
Total of Section A _____		
Section B		
6.	Do you have difficulty or experience problems in mixing arithmetic signs?	Yes No
7.	Did you have any problems learning in elementary school?	Yes No
Total of Section B _____		
Section C		
8.	Do you have difficulty remembering how to spell simple words you know?	Yes No
9.	Do you have difficulty filling out forms?	Yes No
10.	Did you (do you) experience difficulty memorizing numbers?	Yes No
Total of Section C _____		
Section D		
11.	Do you have trouble adding and subtracting small numbers in your head?	Yes No
12.	Do you have difficulty or experience problems taking notes?	Yes No
13.	Were you ever in a special program or given extra help in school?	Yes No
Total of Section D _____		
Total of all Sections (A+B+C+D) _____		

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Name: _____

Section E: Additional Questions

14. What kinds of learning activities do you find difficult if any?

Answer yes to all that apply to you:

- | | | |
|---|-----|----|
| • It's hard for me to speak up in class. | Yes | No |
| • It's sometimes hard for me to understand what people are saying. | Yes | No |
| • It's hard for me to work by myself. | Yes | No |
| • It's hard for me to work with other people. | Yes | No |
| • I get nervous taking tests. | Yes | No |
| • I have trouble finishing what I start. | Yes | No |
| • Too much noise or activity bothers me. | Yes | No |
| • It's hard for me to work when it's too quiet. | Yes | No |
| • I have a lot of things on my mind, so sometimes it's hard for to concentrate. | Yes | No |

Other:

15. What might keep you from coming to class or completing your goals in this program?

Answer yes to all that apply to you:

- | | | |
|---|-----|----|
| • I sometimes have transportation problems. | Yes | No |
| • I have a family member with health problems. | Yes | No |
| • I have child care problems. | Yes | No |
| • I have elderly people to take care of at home. | Yes | No |
| • My work schedule sometimes changes or conflicts with class times. | Yes | No |
| • I am sometimes very tired because of working long hours. | Yes | No |
| • I have a lot of responsibilities. | Yes | No |
| • I'm always thinking about problems at home. | Yes | No |
| • I have family members or friends who don't think I should go to school. | Yes | No |

Other:

16. Do you have difficulty finding or keeping a job you like? Yes No
If so, what makes it hard for you to get or keep this kind of job?

What would help?

Name: _____

Section F: Confidential Questions

- | | | |
|---|-----|----|
| 17. Do you have problems with your vision (eyes)? | Yes | No |
| 18. Have you had your vision checked in the last three years? | Yes | No |
| If so, what kind of eye exam did you have? | | |
| • for near or far-sighted problems? | Yes | No |
| • for cataracts? | Yes | No |
| Other vision problems? | Yes | No |
| Explain: | | |
| 19. Do you need to wear glasses? | Yes | No |
| If so, do you have the correct prescription? | Yes | No |
| 20. Do you have trouble hearing? | Yes | No |
| If so, when was the last time you had your hearing checked? | | |
| 21. Do you have a prescription for a hearing aid? | Yes | No |
| If so, do you wear it? | Yes | No |
| Does the hearing aid work for you? | Yes | No |
| 22. Was school difficult for you? | Yes | No |
| Explain: | | |
| 23. Do you think that you have trouble learning? | Yes | No |
| If yes, what kinds of things do you have trouble with? | | |
| 24. Do you feel you are easily distracted? | Yes | No |
| If yes, what kinds of things distract you? | | |

25.	Have you ever been diagnosed or told you have a		
	• learning disability?	Yes	No
	• an attention deficit?	Yes	No
	If so, by whom?		
	When?		
	What were you told?		
26.	Do you have other problems or disabilities that make studying or working difficult?	Yes	No
	If yes, please describe:		
27.	Do you have documentation of a disability?	Yes	No
	Notes:		
28.	Would you like to request accommodations?	Yes	No
	Notes:		
29.	Have you ever had trouble with any of the following? If so, please explain.		
	• multiple, chronic ear infections	Yes	No
	• multiple, chronic sinus problems	Yes	No
	• serious accidents resulting in head trauma	Yes	No
	• prolonged, high fevers	Yes	No
	• diabetes	Yes	No
	• severe allergies	Yes	No
	• frequent headaches	Yes	No
	• concussion or head injury	Yes	No
	• convulsions or seizures	Yes	No
	• long-term substance abuse problems	Yes	No
	• serious health problems	Yes	No
	Notes:		
30.	Are you taking any medications that would affect the way you function?	Yes	No
	If yes, what are you taking?		
	How often?		